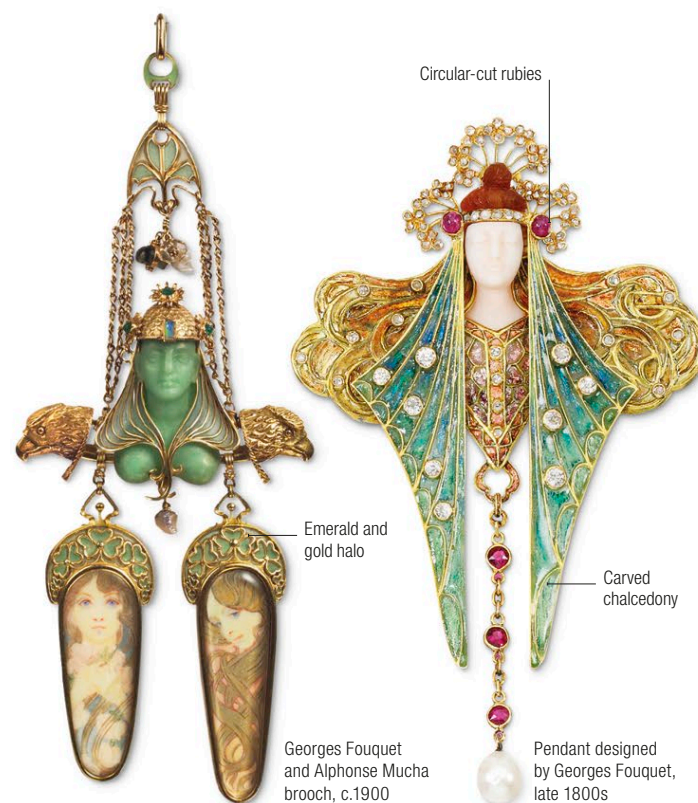


JEWELLERY SHOPPING

The Industrial Revolution changed the way people bought jewellery. Although many pieces were still made by hand, the spread of mass production brought jewellery within the reach of the new middle class, and many designers opened shops to sell their pieces to the general public for the first time. The Art Nouveau movement, with its focus on using gems for their pleasing aesthetics, not necessarily for their value, also helped to make jewellery more affordable.

This can be seen in the work of Parisian designer Georges Fouquet, whose spectacular store on the Rue Royale offered a luxurious shopping experience for the public. The splendid interior, created by Alphonse Mucha, harmonized perfectly with Fouquet's pieces. Jewellery was placed in bubble-shaped display cases, and Mucha skilfully weaved strong, opaque colours throughout the room to emphasize the gemstones.



Alphonse Mucha's shop interior was a celebration of beauty within nature, with vividly-coloured stained-glass panels adorning the walls, and two spectacular peacock sculptures surveying the room. The room's curved lines and jewel-toned colours perfectly complement Fouquet's pieces.